

▲ By The Way...

You'll get a similar message in other applications if you try to save a document to disk with a name that doesn't fit the naming rules of the disk you're saving it on.

Copying On The Same Disk

When we drag files to another directory on the same disk, the Finder assumes we want to move them (instead of making copies) because most of the time, we don't need or want two copies of the same file on our disks. When we actually do want to make a copy of a file on the same disk, we have a couple of alternatives. Unfortunately, none of them are particularly elegant, but they'll have to do. Thankfully, it's probably not something you'll need to do very often.

First is the File menu's "Duplicate..." command. Select the icon you want to make a copy of, then choose this option (or press ⌘-D). The Finder will present you with a dialog (Figure 6L) which allows you to name the new copy of the file. (You can't use the same name as the original because the duplicate copy will be placed into the same window as the original file.) Type a new name or leave the Finder's default name, and click "OK" (or press Return). Now you can drag the duplicate file to its final resting place. If it's important that the new file has the same name as the original, you can rename it after it's been moved.

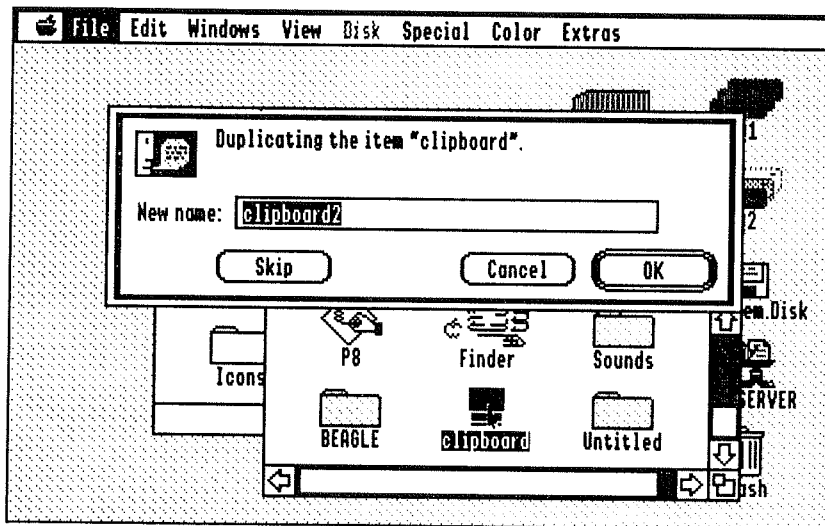


Figure 6L—Duplicate (Make A Copy) Dialog

If you want to copy a group of files that are in a folder, it may be more convenient to duplicate the *folder the items are in* instead of the individual items. Use the pop-up folder menu to bring the folder's parent window to the front, then select the folder and choose "Duplicate..." from the File menu (or, again, press ⌘-D). Click "OK" (or press Return) to accept the name for the new folder. Now you've got two copies of the folder; the contents of both folders have identical names. (The files can have the same names because they're in different folders, but the folders have different names.) Now you can move the duplicated files—or the whole folder.